



The deepest
a submersible
has dived is
more than
35,000 ft
(10,000 m).



SUBMARINES

Submarines are bigger and more powerful than submersibles and can spend months underwater, carrying enough air and food for large crews. Most submarines are used for military purposes, but they can also be used for exploration, scientific research, and salvaging sunken wrecks.

WATER PRESSURE

Pressure is a measure of how much a force presses on a surface. Air presses on surfaces, and water presses on the surface of submerged objects. Pressure is often measured in units called atmospheres (atm)—1 atm is the pressure exerted by air at sea level. The deeper you dive into the ocean, the greater the pressure, because of the increased weight of the water above you. For every 33 ft (10 m) of depth, the water pressure increases by 1 atm. So vehicles that dive very deep have to be very strong.



Most divers only dive up to a depth of 99 ft (30 m), beyond which the pressure can be harmful to the body.



Some submersibles can dive down to 1,640 ft (500 m).



Some submarines can dive to a depth of 0.6 miles (1 km).



Some submersibles can reach depths of nearly 6 miles (10 km), withstanding a pressure of 1,000 atm.